Greece: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Greece's lowest Energy Security percentiles are in upstream gas, upstream electric vehicles and upstream batteries, higher than only 9%, 20% and 21% of the other economies scored. Import needs and unrecorded reserves pull gas down; weak trade, notably small mineral exports, pulls the others down.[1]
- Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in downstream solar, midstream oil and midstream gas, higher than 89%, 85% and 82% of the other economies scored. Investment and production push up solar; exports push up oil and gas.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks upstream batteries 1st and upstream wind 2nd among Greece's own sectors. Policy activity ranks them 7th and 9th.[1,2]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates the United Kingdom highest for Greece, as a reliable supplier, though only its 7th trade partner. China, its 2nd trade partner, ranks only 44th on Partnership Strength.[1,3]

1. Energy security risks and why

14 of Greece's 30 placed sectors sit in the two low-energy-security corners, below the middle economy of their sector on Energy Security, which measures how well a country can rely on what it needs. Its lowest Energy Security percentiles are in upstream gas (score 0.26, Secure corner), upstream electric vehicles (0.18, Upgrade corner) and upstream batteries (0.19, Secure corner). There it scores higher than only 9%, 20% and 21% of the other economies scored.[1]

In upstream gas the score is low mainly because of the energy imports and reserves categories. Production minus consumption was -0.256 EJ in 2025; the figure takes production from the U.S. Energy Information Administration's international statistics, as the Energy Institute does not report it separately. No gas reserves are recorded, which the index counts as zero. For context, its largest suppliers in 2024 were Russia (45.5% of imports), the United States (26.5%) and Azerbaijan (18.3%).[3,4,5]

In upstream electric vehicles and upstream batteries, the trade and minerals trade categories pull the score down. Greece's share of world exports of the minerals these technologies use was <0.1% in 2024. On that measure it scores higher than 37% and 26% of the other economies. For context, Gabon supplied 74.5% and 73.5% of its imports in these baskets.[1,3,6]

Its high-priority sectors, upstream electric grid, upstream green hydrogen and midstream solar, sit in the Upgrade corner, which pairs high opportunity with low energy security. In upstream electric grid the score is held down mainly by the trade category: its trade deficit in these goods was 0.4% of GDP in 2023. In

midstream solar its Energy Security of 0.34 sits just under the sector median of 0.35. For context, China supplied 50.4% of its imports there in 2024.[1,3,7]

2. Economic opportunities and why

20 of its 30 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners, above the middle economy of their sector on Economic Opportunity, which measures how well placed a country is to create value. Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in downstream solar (0.61), midstream oil (0.63) and midstream gas (0.60). There it scores higher than 89%, 85% and 82% of the other economies scored. Each sits in the Grow corner, which the framework associates with building on strength through export promotion.[1]

In downstream solar the investment and production categories push the score up. On annual investment it scores higher than 88% of the other economies, and solar power production reached 10.4 TWh in 2025.[1,4]

In the midstream sectors, the trade and cost competitiveness categories push the scores up. Its revealed comparative advantage was 1.73 in midstream oil and 1.47 in midstream gas in 2024. For context, its largest market for both baskets in 2024 was Israel (39.8% and 40.0%), followed by Italy.[3,8]

In upstream electric grid, a high-priority sector, its Economic Opportunity is higher than 71% of the other economies scored.[1]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by opportunity, security need, policy activity, stage and low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it ranks upstream batteries 1st among Greece's own sectors, at 0.66, 0.013 ahead of the next. Security need, which rises as Energy Security falls, contributes the most: 0.244. Next come upstream wind (2nd), upstream nuclear (3rd), upstream solar (4th) and upstream electric grid (5th), each almost tied with the sector below it, by 0.003, 0.001, 0.003 and 0.005. Policy activity lifts downstream solar to 6th: it ranks 1st on policy but 19th on priority, the Strategic Index without its policy term.[1,2]

Greece's allied pick, its top upstream or midstream sector after a resource screen, is upstream nuclear, 0.025 ahead of midstream batteries. The higher-ranked upstream batteries and upstream wind are screened out: the data record no resource base for them.[9]

Policy activity counts International Energy Agency policy records and the Climate Action Tracker rating, which favours low-emission technologies over coal, oil and gas. Greece has 134 such records, 73 of which name a technology, and carries the European Union's Climate Action Tracker rating, Insufficient. Policy activity and priority broadly agree: no top priority has the least policy, and no bottom priority has the most. Top priority and the most policy coincide in upstream batteries, upstream wind, midstream batteries and midstream solar; bottom priority and the least policy in 7 coal, oil and gas sectors. Among the top priorities, policy is weakest in midstream green hydrogen and upstream green hydrogen (top third on priority, 19th and 18th on policy). For context, the Country Insights page lists the strongest active industrial-policy measures that Global Trade Alert records under Greece, including EU-wide ones; they do not count towards policy activity.[1,2,10]

4. Partnership priorities and why

From Greece's viewpoint, the Partnership Strength Index rates the United Kingdom highest, as a reliable supplier strongest in downstream geothermal, upstream electric vehicles, upstream wind, upstream solar and downstream batteries. The index combines how reliable a supplier a partner is (Friendshore), how good a market it is (Partnership Opportunity) and, for lower-income partners, Development Potential. Romania ranks 2nd and Israel 3rd, both as an export market, followed by Italy (4th, reliable supplier) and the Netherlands (5th, reliable supplier).[1]

Today's ties match these ranks in part. Italy, the Netherlands and Israel are its 3rd, 4th and 5th trade partners on average across its energy-goods baskets; the United Kingdom and Romania are its 7th and 8th. Germany, its 1st trade partner, ranks 8th on Partnership Strength. The reverse case is China: its 2nd trade partner, it ranks 44th and rates best as a development partner. Turkiye, its 6th trade partner, likewise ranks only 39th. China shares none of Greece's economic-security agreements, and their UN votes put them in opposite blocs. Turkiye shares NATO with Greece but is nonaligned in UN votes.[1,3,11,12]

As a partner to the coalition, Greece ranks 28th of 192 economies on Partnership Strength averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design its shares are derived from the European Union's: they are largest in midstream green hydrogen (0.3% of designed coalition production) and midstream gas (0.2%).[1,9]

5. Data notes and caveats

Figures are as of 12 October 2026. Scores compare Greece with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Some figures behind these scores are filled in where the source has no value: with zero where a source lists every holder, otherwise with the world average. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up. In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; Greece's shares are derived from its weight within the EU. The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; Greece carries the EU's rating. Greece's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records. Trade figures count trade with other EU members.

Sources

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